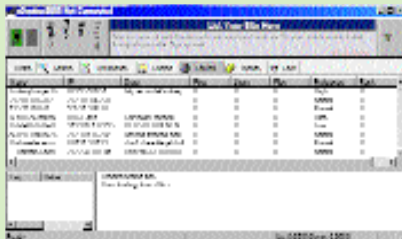


Sharing Media

A relatively recent development, P2P tools allow you to share music, videos and other files over the Internet. eDonkey (www.edonkey.com) is one such network with millions of users worldwide. The network monitors media across all sub-



Peer-to-peer file-sharing with eDonkey

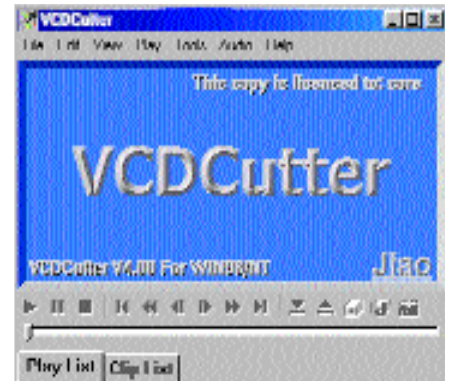
scribers, so all you need to do is install a client, search for what you want, select one from the results and download it. The file will be downloaded directly from the person who has it. This is extremely convenient and fast, since files don't need to be hosted on an Internet server first and the software unobtrusively downloads files in the background.

movie in MPEG-1 format. For this you can use TMPGEnc (www.tmpegenc.net), a free tool that converts almost any movie to this format by just selecting the input file and one of the available templates that has default settings for the kind of output file. The conversion speed depends on the PC configuration, the movie length and frame complexity. Almost any CD burning software can burn the MPEG-1 file to a VCD that can be played on standard VCD players. Nero Burning ROM (www.nero.com) is one of the best CD writing applications around. Launch the software and a wizard guides you through the CD creation process in just a few clicks. Select VideoCD as the CD type, drag the movie file into the project and Nero will take care of the rest.



Encoding movies with TMPGEnc

Ripping VCDs is a different ball game. VCD Cutter (www.seller-club.com/~vcdcut/) saves the entire movie or parts of it on the hard disk and scales the movie size. It can also save just the movie audio or merge a video source (M1V file) with an audio source (MP3 file). It has a built-in AVI to MPEG converter



VCD Cutter outputs MPEG files from VCDs

Get a hold of these cool applications and turn your PC into a complete entertainment studio. You needn't look too far; most of these are on the Mindware CD accompanying this issue.

VEER KOTHARI

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